No-Win Situation

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/90016291.

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Explicit

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Characters:
Angella (She-Ra), Juliet (She-Ra)

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by ManInTheBlueSuit

Summary

General Juliet has been a steadfast soldier with sworn loyalty to Queen Angella, and has taken a vow to do whatever it takes to keep her happy, even if it means denying herself until ordered to prove that she is capable of knowing what love even is.

[OR]

A brief pre-canon smuttening where Juliet has relations with Angella in the war room.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

It had been years since she had been forced to lead the Rebellion alone, and each day was harder than the last. No matter how much she strove to protect her kingdom, the Horde grew more determined each day, erasing entire villages that stood between them and unquestioned tyranny of all Etheria. Somehow, every problem ended being passed up the chain until it reached her. Some days, it was all she could do to keep from screaming.

And now, reports out of Plumeria were that the plant life was being afflicted by some sort of blight. Honestly, what did they expect her to do? She was trained in affairs of state, of logistics and rationing. Tending a garden was outside her area of expertise. Besides, Perfuma's powers were the exact resource that problem required - why even bring it to her attention?

She laid the folder aside for later, reaching for the bottle at her side. The benefit of working in the war room was the silence and privacy that afforded her clarity of mind. The downside was the steady level of light masking the passing hours.

"Ma'am?" Angella startled, the wine bottle knocked over to roll towards the edge as she turned.

General Juliet wordlessly caught the receptacle as it reached the precipice. "Juliet," Angella took a deep breath to steady her nerves as Juliet placed the bottle back on the table. "How long have you been there?"

"Since the beginning." She reported drily.

"Forgive me," Angella apologised. "My focus was on the reports."

"No forgiveness necessary," Juliet nodded respectfully. "Your duties take priority."

"I'm currently looking at a report that a nature Princess is having troubles growing plants, while staring down some resource problems of my own." She smiled whimsically at the empty bottle.

"Perhaps I can help with that." Reaching behind a hip, Juliet retrieved a slim flask, and picked the glass from the table. "I keep a little something on hand," Juliet confessed as she poured a measure into Angella's chalice. "If there is something to celebrate, a small sip amongst the soldiers is hardly grounds for court martial. If there's something to mourn," She paused, before adding a trickle more to the sadly smiling queen's cup. "A little fortification wouldn't hurt."

"And what if the Horde were to strike?" Angella raised her drink to take a cautious sip. Her eyes faintly watered, and she felt years shaved off her immortal life.

"Well then," Juliet took a slug straight from her flask, and Angella wondered how she trained herself to cope with the burning pain. "I suppose that we would have more important matters to focus on." One of the small facets that Angella had noticed about her right-hand general over the last few years was how she smiled. A lot of the time, it was a perfectly straight expression. Not a smile, as much a suspension of the sternness that usually occupied her face.

"Would you say that I am a coward, Juliet?"

"No, ma'am." Juliet swiftly denied the absurd notion.

"I can barely handle my own daughter!" She thumped the table in exasperation. "Every time I try sending her on a safe mission, she is determined to push boundaries; fighting back, arguing that we should be pushing further!"

Juliet laid a comforting hand on Angella's shoulder. "You are our leader, ma'am," She admitted. "But, that does not mean that you are alone in this fight - we are all with you. It is not all your responsibility."

Angella laid her hand over Juliet's without looking up. "If that were true, I would have to blame someone else for Micah's death," She said heavily. "And I will not lay that burden on any

other." She tried to slip the hand off her shoulder, only for the grip to tighten.

"With all respect, *Your Majesty*," Angella had never heard that tone in Juliet's tone before, and she looked up to see an expression nearing anger. "There is another person you should blame - Hordak. You want to blame someone else? King Micah."

"How dare you!" Angella rose to her full height as she bellowed the words.

"How dare *I?*" Juliet shouted back. "How dare *you*! King Micah was a good man, and he was every bit as cowardly as you think you are! He ran into that battle for the same reasons that you don't leave Bright Moon - for *love*, Queen Angella, for you and Princess Glimmer."

"What would *you* know about love?" Angella finally snapped. "Every report from your squad calls you uncaring, every rumour says that you have a heart worthy of the Northern Reaches. You never take a personal day from your duties, always either out on the field or guarding at my side." It felt good to be angry, to let out all the impotent rage that filled her. And Juliet could take it, she never showed any emotion, no matter how long the hours she spent at Angella's side. It was impossible to make her take any leave. The last time that she had commanded it, Juliet had simply ordered one of the other guards to hand over their more concealing helmet, and taken up position in the throne room while she held court. Stars, Angella had never known her to show the slightest bit of interest in anyone. How could she, when every day was spent with… her?

Juliet didn't seem phased as Angella fell back into her seat, gripping the hand on her shoulder. "How long?" She asked.

"Would it matter?" Juliet responded evenly.

"How do you know it's even real?"

It was tentative, that first kiss. Like the dancing of moonlight across her lips. Angella's guts clenched. She hadn't been kissed since the morning that Micah had walked into battle and never come back. It felt wrong to be kissed again. It felt worse that she liked it. And it felt sacrilege that she turned her face for more.

Juliet complied, like a good solider. Exploring the new territory, charting the surroundings, dusting lips across the sharp corners of Angella's jawline. "May I?" She breathed, fingers ghosting down her collarbone into the hollow on her queen's throat. Right over the fastening for her cape.

Angella couldn't agree, couldn't betray herself like that.

Juliet deftly undid the clasp as Angella tilted her head back, exposing herself to the soldier under her command. Spreading back the cape like she was unwrapping a precious gift, she admired the sight of her reason for being, eyes fluttered shut, head tilted back, lips parted in breathless anticipation. There was a pounding in her throat, the subtle pulse of an artery under pressure that only doctors and soldiers learned to recognise. And, like the solider she was, Juliet struck her target.

Angella gasped as teeth faintly latched onto her neck, Juliet biting softly as she worried the point. A startled groan filled her chest as the impact bit deeper, and one hand flew to her mouth. "Don't," A soft pop announced Juliet's mouth leaving her throat, and Angella cursed herself for missing the sensations it had been providing. "I want to hear."

Metal plates clinked as Juliet swung her knee over Angella's leg, leaning a palm against the ornate chair for leverage as she gazed upon perfection. If she was unworthy of looking, then kissing her again was damnation. Well, she was caught in a damned war anyway, might as well go out with a prize in her grasp.

Years of fighting had taught Juliet to recognise every subtle movement. That was how she could see Angella lean in the smallest amount before their lips made contact again. Her lips

were soft, pillowy, like collapsing into her cot after leading a training session all day. Juliet retreated, reassessed, advanced, returned. Conquest had never tasted so sweet, and she sought new frontiers to capture. Tracing over the aquiline planes of her nose, rounding across her cheeks, renewing the mark she had left on the elegant splendour of the neck.

Lips weren't the only thing that wandered. Both hands traced as soft as a scout's steps, moving down Angella's shoulders, sliding around her upper arms, hooking into the top of her leotard.

"Wait!" Angella managed the one word past the swirling emotions that gripped her.

"Your Majesty?" Juliet drew back.

"Nobody has," Angella cut off the breathless confession. "Not since Glimmer."

Oh? Juliet swallowed her grin before it could bloom.

"I remember when you were pregnant with Glimmer," Juliet smiled softly, staring into Angella's eyes. "I was only a brigadier then, under old Sely. I remember seeing you and King Micah, and I thought that you were so beautiful every day. Sely knew, the smug bastard. He warned me that nothing could come of it. I told him what I'll tell you now - I don't care. My only interest was in making sure that you were happy. And I saw, I *saw*," She rocked her knee unconsciously, calling another gasp from Angella's lips. Juliet forced her leg to stop. "I saw how much you loved them, and how much Micah loved you. And I promised to take protect that love with all my heart. You want to know who failed your husband?" Tears built in her eyes. "I was shadowing King Micah in the battle where he fell by, to protect him. We got separated. Tanks were closing in on one of our platoons. King Micah," She swallowed. "King Micah ordered me to start retrieving the wounded while he dealt with the tanks. I must have dragged a dozen soldiers back to our lines before I realised that the tanks stopped firing. I should have stopped him, I should have,"

For the first time in nearly twenty years, Angella kissed someone. Not a soft kiss, not a gentle peck on her child's forehead. She leaned in, pressing her mouth to Juliet's, a thumb wiping away the saltwater crawling down her cheek. "It wasn't your fault," She whispered, tears reflecting in her own eyes. "Micah was stubborn like Glimmer is. As soon as he saw people in danger, he was going to put himself into danger to protect them."

She kissed her soldier again, hungrier this time. She tasted like fire, and strength, and grief. She tasted like vengeance. She tasted like war.

Juliet was everything that Angella needed. The way her teeth sunk into her neck, the way her hair batted gently off the shoulder, a tiny lovetap to let her know of the next incursion. Stars, Angella had never thought about of all the muscles that went into wielding a weapon, because she couldn't have imagined the strength and dexterity of the calloused palm sliding over her heart, frantically cupping over the pounding organ, tugging and taunting the erect summit of her breast. A knee pressed against her core, and she whimpered, Juliet whispering hushed assurances as she nibbled her earlobe, and braced an arm around her shoulders.

Angella stifled her groans, frantically trying to turn the tables. Tugging the braid, she forced her lips to Juliet's, her nerve failing to carry her any further. Fortunately, years closely serving had taught the soldier how to anticipate what her queen needed.

Sighing through her nose, Juliet opened her mouth enough to let her know it was alright as she tightened her grip around Angella's shoulders.

It was an accident, Angella would later argue. That the sudden pressure from behind, the impact of knee into the fork of her legs, both of which caused her to gasp, to arch upward and slip her tongue into Juiet's mouth.

She balled her fist, barely able to resist the urge to nip playfully at the guest. Angella was shy, reserved, scarcely reaching past her lips at first. Juliet fluttered an eyelid to check on her. There was a worried frown appearing between her brows, the one that always appeared when she was fighting herself to make the hard choice. Juliet's heart tightened as she flattened her palm, gently stroking along the smooth skin, fingertips dusting the very edges of the wings.

With a gasp, Angella suddenly shunted them apart.

"Your Majesty, I'm sorry!" Juliet tried to shift away, but was caught in an iron grip.

"They're, they're sensitive at the base." Angella gasped, chest heaving.

Softness filled the brown eyes of the soldier. Even after all these years, she had never known that about her ruler. "I won't them." She promised.

"No, they, er," Angella stammered. "They're *sensitive* at the base." Softness was replaced by savagery. She had shown weakness to a warrior, and the warrior now knew when to strike.

"May I?" She whispered, lifting a hand.

In another life, maybe Juliet was a musician. From the subtle ministrations as she trailed along the base of her wings with a feather's touch, to the tunes she cradled from Angella's trembling gasps, it was a performance of a truly dedicated artist, one who had spent years studying their instrument.

Worse, Juliet was adept at adaptation - peeling down the upper ridge of Angella's top, her mouth watered slightly at the bountiful sight. The queen didn't have time to blush before she was attacked again. Juliet dragged her close, feasting on one supple breast ahead of the other. She may have been sworn to defend the queen from all harm, but that oath was clearly lesser to her allegiance as she gently worried a nipple between her teeth,

tenderly stroking the base of the wings with a counterpoint tenderness. It was impossible to adjust, torn between brutality and compassion, enthralled by her subordinate.

But it didn't feel right to be the only one benefiting. "M-May I?" She groaned as Juliet leaned back to examine her work.

"I am yours to command," Juliet reminded her, biting her lip as Angella moved her hand to the waistband of her trousers. The undershirt that protected her from her armour was slowly untucked. Flight was an exertion like nothing else, but Juliet's daily training regime had carved muscles as if from granite. Feeling the gentle touch stroking along her abdominals, she wondered if it was how having her wings stroked felt. Satin touches, barely registering, yet clawing at her senses. Then the fingers drifted lower, tugging at the waistband of her briefs.

She didn't wait for the question this time, simply setting her jaw and raising on both knees to stare Angella in her pearlescent eyes, ordering her to continue.

Flinching before the gaze, she slid her fingers lower.

Juliet stopped breathing.

Angella mirrored the action.

"*Please*, Your Majesty," Juliet breathed, watching her breath fog over the forehead gem, briefly reflecting a visage that she would have been ashamed to let anyone see, especially her queen, had she not been the cause. "I swear, I,"

She groaned as fingers traced along her vulva.

"Juliet?"Angella's voice was breathless with wonder and disbelief. "Is that," She watched her groan again, fingertips growing slick as she traced over the folds under her touch.

"Lower." She ordered, leaning on the broad shoulders, eyes closed in blissed concentration.

The immortal watched in amazement as Juliet's hips bucked under the slightest touch. "Angella," It was the first time that she'd ever said the name with a title or precursor, and the tone was a curious mixture of begging and commanding as her eyes fluttered open. What lay beneath were terrifying pools of forbidden hungers that were finally being fed. "*Keep going.*"

Compelled to seize her lips, Angella swallowed Juliet's frantic gasp as she slipped a finger inside. "There," Juliet gasped as she rocked her hips. "Stars, *there!*" She was magnificent on the battlefield, but Angella had never seen her top general as enthralling as when she was forced by her body to dance on Angella's probing touch, her face wracked in ecstasy.

Juliet gave a warrior's cry as the slender fingers curled *exactly right*, touching a bundle of nerves that had her seeing the ancient constellations carved on the ceiling burst into electrifying illumination. Then she collapsed, forehead resting breathlessly against the object of her desire.

"That was…" Juliet cleared her throat, trying to regain some semblance of decency as she righted herself. "Your Majesty." She adjusted her clothing as the visiting appendage withdrew.

Stars, she had never seen a sight as enthralling as the glistening dew spread like gossamer. A primeval urge seized control of her, and Angella sucked both fingers into her mouth, softly cleaning the juices from her hand.

Juliet's eyes, exhausted only an instant before, flared into new burning pits of desire. "It wouldn't be right," She growled, extending both feet to the floor. "To let my duties go unfulfilled."

"Unfulfilled?" Angella echoed in confusion. Between the many ministrations that Juliet had already visited, she was sure that Juliet had *more* than fulfilled her duties by now.

Sliding down the queen's body, Juliet peeled away the leotard and leggings, planting teasing kisses on the freshly exposed expanse

as she went. "General, that's not," Angella tried to object out of a fading sense of responsibility.

"*Hush*," She was gently chided as the final goal was brought into glistening view. If anything, Angella seemed even more aroused now than Juliet had been moments ago. "Let me." As carefully as she would nock an arrow, Juliet gently slipped a finger into the sodden folds as the angelic being gasped above her.

How would she cope tomorrow, and every day after, knowing that she would be sitting in a chair that had been soiled with her slick, made to come undone as she gripped the table hard enough to whiten her fingers?

It wasn't possible to put a name to the taste. Only if dragged into the Fright Zone and tortured for months by Hordak himself would Juliet admit that the sensation was like being caressed by a thousand fluttering wings, that the fluids coating her tongue, being desperately swallowed like she was dying of dehydration in the Crimson Wastes and this were the only liquid in reach, defined taste, seeming to invert the universe as they made contact with her senses. It was a fragment of magic made manifest, filling her with such a feeling that she knew she could never return to that pitiful existence that she had been before.

"Ju. Li. Et!" The syllables were gasped brokenly above her.

She levered her mouth away from the barest moment. "Hush," She said gently. "*Let go.*" Then she returned to her divine work.

A pulse of light detonated around the room as Angella screamed her release, a veritable fountain crashing against the unceasingly ravenous mouth trying to devour her.

The laps and movements slowed in tandem with her abating elation, smoothing out like waves on the ocean. As awareness came back to her body, Queen Angella realized that she was still being gently serviced, like a fire kept softly burning deep into the night.

"I didn't think that I could do this without Micah," She rasped, voice hoarse from the screaming. "But you've been by my side this entire time." How could she have never realised it before?

"Tomorrow," Smirking at Angella's pretty gasp as she withdrew her fingers, Juliet crawled up, spreading the slick around those flushed lips in a shimmering coating. "I'll order Glimmer to examine the defences around Elberon. It's remote, isolated from the Horde. We've had no reports of activity in the area."

"Will," Angella looked so beautiful like that, her face flushed, hair in dishevelled disarray, and lips shining so perfectly with both of their juices. "Will you protect her?"

"Your Majesty," Juliet crooned, plucking her thumb against Angella's lower lip as she leaned their foreheads together, hair carelessly falling over her shoulder. "I swore long ago that I would put your happiness above my own. If there is ever anything I can do to help Glimmer, she will not even have to ask."

Strong fingers threaded into her hair as Angella was engulfed by the taste of both their juices, and the soft strokes of Juliet's tongue against her own.

End Notes

Observant readers may notice that Juliet's attempt to keep Glimmer safe by escorting her to an isolated locale backfire worse than Entrapta's idea for an electric sponge.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!